Ukraine's Military Has Less Access to Starlink

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Ukraine's **military** has lost some access to Starlink, Ukrainian officials say. Starlink is a **satellite** internet system that Ukraine has used during its war with Russia.

Starlink is run by Elon Musk's company SpaceX. It uses more than 11,000 **satellites** that circle close to Earth. A safer **military** version is called Starshield.

It is not clear why the limits started. On Wednesday, Musk wrote on X that Starshield is owned and controlled by the U.S. government. He said any limits would have been ordered by the U.S. **military** and the president. The U.S. government had not answered yet, CBC News reported.

An adviser to Ukraine's president said the limits included a speed limit on Starlink equipment on **drones**. Ukraine uses the network for **drones**, **air defense** and supplies.

Experts say Starlink helps soldiers talk with faraway leaders, and it is very hard for enemies to **block**.

Word Treasure

satellite -- A satellite is a machine in space that circles Earth and sends signals.
military -- The military is a country's army and other armed forces.
drones -- Drones are flying machines controlled from far away, with no pilot on board.
air defense -- Air defense is the work of protecting an area from attacks from the sky.
block -- To block a signal means to stop it from getting through.

Background you need

Starlink sends internet signals from many satellites in space to dishes on the ground.

Because it works from space, it can help people connect where phone lines are broken, such as in a war zone.

Russia and Ukraine have been at war, and Ukraine's military has used Starlink to stay in touch.

Break it down

WHO: Ukraine's military, Elon Musk and his company SpaceX
WHAT: Ukraine's military has lost some access to Starlink satellite internet
WHERE: Ukraine, during its war with Russia
WHY: It is not clear; Musk says any limits would have been ordered by the U.S. government

Why it matters

It shows how internet from space has become very important, even helping a country stay connected during a war.

Test what you remember

1. What has Ukraine's military lost some access to?

- (A) Its schools
- (B) Starlink
- (C) Television
- (D) Its airplanes

2. Which company runs Starlink?

- (A) SpaceX
- (B) YouTube
- (C) NASA
- (D) Nintendo

3. About how many satellites does Starlink use?

- (A) More than 11,000
- (B) Exactly 500
- (C) About 2
- (D) Only 10

4. What is the military version of Starlink called?

- (A) Moonlink
- (B) Starboat
- (C) Starshield
- (D) Skynet

5. Who did Musk say owns and controls Starshield?

- (A) Ukraine
- (B) A school
- (C) The U.S. government
- (D) Russia

6. Why do experts say Starlink is helpful?

- (A) It helps soldiers talk with faraway leaders and is hard to block
- (B) It makes food
- (C) It works only in cities
- (D) It is very cheap

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Elon Musk: He says the U.S. military and president would have ordered any limits.

2. Ukrainian officials: They say the military has lost some access, including a speed limit on drone equipment.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):